DEADLINE

THE ROBNER CASE

A maximum-outcome route to the conviction of Baxter and Dunbar

A concise, deterministic investigation guide for Infocom's 1982 mystery

STORY SCORE	CASE RESULT	DEATHS	VM INSTRUCTIONS
Not scored No numeric score in Deadline	**Both convicted** Best ending confirmed	**0** No deaths in the run	**323,441** Fresh deterministic replay

Verified story: Z-machine V3, Release 27, Serial 831005. The replay reaches the case-solved ending; the commissioner's letter confirms a jury convicted both suspects. Deadline uses time and date in its status display rather than a numerical score counter, so this guide records the best available case outcome.

Replay checkpoint: 219 submitted command lines, fixed random seed 1, 60 unique opcodes, no VM fault, and no player deaths. The trace's output fingerprint is `DFBF122F96E54E9A…32B06284`.

Story fingerprint: SHA-256 `DF14B33428BFF5057B6569427DA5D9BE3CCB92497B6D2D0EA7B1D3821739D629`.

How to use this guide

Follow the numbered stages in order. Courier blocks show the commands to enter. When a timed wait asks whether to continue, answer **yes** for ordinary interruptions and **no** when the mailman delivers the envelope or when the specified observation is complete. If you need to carry a dropped clue, make room by dropping already-read items.

Route checkpoints

- Reconstruct the note to Baxter and the new-will appointment.
- Recover the intercepted letter and the merger article; expose George's hidden will and Focus papers.
- Link the teacup fragment to LoBlo and inspect the balcony scrape.
- Use Dunbar's concert stub to contradict Baxter, then arrest both suspects.

The investigation

01. Establish the motives

Enter the house, inspect the library pad and calendar, then return to the Front Path. The pad points toward Baxter; the July 8 calendar entry confirms a newly completed will. At 9:17, stop the timed wait when the mailman hands over the envelope. Read it, then keep waiting for Baxter and show him the pad.

```
go north
knock on front door
go north
go east
go up
go up
go west (four times)
go north
take pad
take calendar
carefully examine pad
hold pad up to light
turn calendar
go south
go east (four times)
go down (twice)
go west
go south
open front door
go south
wait until 10:00  [answer no at the envelope]
open envelope
read letter
wait for Baxter  [answer yes until he arrives]
show pad to Baxter
```

Wait until 11:00, continuing through distractions. Use ordinary waits until the paperboy throws the newspaper; read both sections, especially the financial report on the Omnidyne merger. Attend the will reading with George and Coates.

```
wait until 11:00  [answer yes to continue]
wait (repeat until paperboy; answer no when he arrives)
take newspaper
read newspaper
read second section
go north (twice)
go west
wait for George  [continue through interruptions]
show calendar to George
sit
wait for Coates  [continue through interruptions]
```

02. Catch George with the new will

After Coates reads the older will, get up and follow George upstairs. He hides in the library's secret room. Wait on the balcony until he enters and opens the secret shelf, then return to the library and inspect the shelves. Press the hidden button after two waits to catch him with the new will. Read the papers in the safe; they establish Baxter's Focus fraud and George's inheritance motive.

```
get up
go east (twice)
go up (twice)
go west (four times, to End of Hallway)
go north
open balcony door
go north
wait for George  [yes when he enters; no after he opens the shelf]
go south
carefully examine bookshelves
wait
wait
press button
take will
examine safe
take papers
read papers
```

Method and resolution

03. Establish the murder method

Find McNabb at the orchard path, listen, and ask him to show you the holes. Follow him into the rose garden. Search the dirt around the holes (not just the ground) to recover the porcelain, clean it, and request Duffy’s routine analysis. Inspect the muddy ladder and use it to climb to the balcony; the railing has a scraped patch. Then check Dunbar’s medicine cabinet and request a LoBlo-specific analysis of the fragment.

```
go west (to Library)
go south
go east (four times)
go down (twice)
go west
go south (twice, to Front Path)
go east
go northeast
go east
go northwest
take ladder
listen to McNabb
McNabb, show me holes
go west
go south
search dirt
clean porcelain
analyze porcelain
wait for Duffy
go north
go east
[retrieve ladder if McNabb took it]
go west
go south
climb ladder
examine railing
go south (twice)
go east (four times)
go south (twice)
open medicine cabinet
examine LoBlo
analyze porcelain for LoBlo
wait for Duffy
```

04. Break the alibis and close the case

Show the lab report to Dunbar in her bedroom. Use repeated WAIT commands until she leaves, then follow her downstairs, and wait in North of Foyer until she walks past. Follow her to the Front Path and pick up the ticket stub. If carrying it drops the lab report, lighten your inventory and pick the report back up. Dunbar admits she went to the concert with Baxter; the stub contradicts his earlier account. Follow Baxter to the North Lawn, show him the stub, and arrest both. Decline the optional author's summary to end cleanly.

```
go north (twice)
go west
go south
show lab report to Dunbar
wait (repeat until Dunbar leaves; answer no at departure)
go north
go east
go down (twice)
go west
wait for Dunbar
go south (twice)
take ticket stub
show ticket stub to Dunbar
[track Baxter: East Side -> East Lawn -> Orchard -> Garden Path -> North Lawn]
[look and follow his reported direction if he moved on]
show ticket stub to Baxter
arrest Baxter and Dunbar
no
```

End-state verification

The final output says "You have solved the case!" and includes the commissioner's confirmation that Baxter and Dunbar were convicted. No player-death event occurred. Deadline does not expose a numeric score or move score in its status line; the two convictions are the documented best ending. The route and opcode trace are kept locally under `.agent/regression-routes/` for replay.

Opcode inventory

Unique opcodes executed by the deterministic fresh-game route. Counts cover all 323,441 executed instructions. First sequence is 1-based; PCs are hexadecimal byte addresses.

Form	Opcode	Mnemonic	Count	First sequence	First PC
Long	13	store	13,300	1	0x004F25
Long	10	test_attr	5,483	9	0x004F3D
Variable	7	random	80	10	0x004F42
Long	20	add	12,091	11	0x004F46
Variable	0	call	13,995	12	0x004F4A
Variable	20	add	515	14	0x004DDD
Long	1	je	35,874	16	0x004DE7
Long	21	sub	11,586	17	0x004DEB
Short	0	jz	56,824	18	0x004DEF
Variable	1	storew	12,209	20	0x004DFA
Short	11	ret	2,727	21	0x004DFF
Long	15	loadw	42,281	32	0x004E01
Short	12	jump	28,754	35	0x004E0F
Short	0	rtrue	1,041	578	0x01760B
Short	2	print	803	580	0x006BBD
Variable	9	and	1	582	0x006C48
Variable	6	print_num	76	583	0x006C4E
Long	5	inc_chk	15,336	585	0x006C60
Long	16	loadb	5,151	586	0x006C67
Variable	5	print_char	111	587	0x006C6B
Short	11	new_line	575	611	0x006C71
Long	14	insert_obj	295	614	0x004FAE
Variable	8	push	1,440	618	0x006882
Variable	9	pull	225	620	0x00688B
Long	11	set_attr	60	622	0x006892
Long	6	jin	1,666	624	0x006898
Short	10	print_obj	238	625	0x00689C
Short	3	get_parent	2,071	628	0x0068A6
Long	17	get_prop	2,929	631	0x0068D9
Short	13	print_paddr	196	637	0x0068EF

Opcode inventory (continued)

Form	Opcode	Mnemonic	Count	First sequence	First PC
Variable	21	sub	742	647	0x00901C
Long	2	jl	5,686	648	0x009022
Short	2	get_child	3,765	665	0x0090FE
Short	5	inc	2,886	666	0x009159
Short	1	get_sibling	3,606	674	0x00914C
Variable	1	je	6,847	734	0x006A03
Short	8	ret_popped	1,486	754	0x006940
Long	4	dec_chk	1,980	807	0x005329
Variable	4	sread	219	813	0x005339
Long	7	test	2,197	833	0x00568F
Long	3	jg	7,313	838	0x005693
Long	9	and	1,299	839	0x005697
Long	22	mul	533	849	0x005530
Variable	2	storeb	407	852	0x00553C
Short	1	rfalse	2,931	924	0x00AB8D
Long	18	get_prop_addr	6,061	940	0x006D8F
Short	4	get_prop_len	3,408	942	0x006D97
Short	3	print_ret	110	992	0x0097C9
Variable	3	jg	453	1,054	0x004E24
Variable	13	store	124	2,003	0x006177
Long	23	div	2,670	2,020	0x0066DB
Variable	2	jl	3	2,252	0x00FD31
Short	9	remove_obj	4	2,259	0x00FEE3
Long	12	clear_attr	11	2,395	0x00FF66
Long	19	get_next_prop	466	2,581	0x0173CC
Short	12	show_status	262	12,509	0x007728
Long	24	mod	36	39,710	0x0093BA
Short	7	print_addr	1	102,649	0x005EFB
Short	14	load	1	217,010	0x006E0F
Short	10	quit	1	323,441	0x015EC0

Replay metadata: V3 / Release 27 / Serial 831005 · seed 1 · halted cleanly · output SHA-256 DFBF122F96E54E9A458FE49319EA732514C4E564835C8B61FC15F28832B06284